

Incident Alert 0013-1. TLP Green.			Date	Breakout Scale
BE, FR – Unlabelled Political ads Targeting Brussels City and France with Anti-Qatar Videos (Updated).			17/06/2024	2

Summary

- 34 unlabelled political ads are attempting to smear the reputation of the Qatari royal family using Meta ads.
- The ads target the Belgian city of Brussels and the country of France with two English language videos.
- The ad's videos claimed Qatar is trying to Islamize Europe and that the Qatari royal family is morally corrupt.
- The page was activated or repurposed on June 13 and it's ads reached at least 4,2 million users by June 15.
- Flagged ads and page to Meta, informed European governments.

Incident – When, Who did what, to say what, to whom, why?

Between June 13 and 15, the **Facebook** page *Europe First* posted **34 ads** targeting the Belgian city of **Brussels** and the country of **France** with an **English-language video** discrediting the **royal family of Qatar** ([1](#)). One of the videos claim that Qatar has a plan to **Islamize Europe** and another discredits the Qatari royal family ([2](#), [3](#)). The videos portray themselves as they are a part of a series with multiple episodes. The videos have not been found online otherwise. One of the videos have a watermark saying “**CBN TV**” which is an American Christian media company, while the other does not. The post used in the active ad remain as a post on the pages ([4](#)). The inactive ad is not visible on the page as its own post.

18 of the ads are still **active** and **none** of the 34 ads are **labelled** as **political content**, breaking Meta's **advertisement policy**. The ads are using **Facebook**, **Instagram**, and **Meta's Audience Network**.

The page was created in **2021** but was activated for this use on **June 13**, adding the accounts imagery ([5](#), [6](#)). The page is seemingly trying to avoid Meta's automated content moderation by using a Unicode characters name.

Considering that the video is in **English** while **targeting Brussels** specifically, it is possible that the target audience of the ads are expats, including employees of the EU institutions.

17/06/2024 update: The pages were taken down but the

Narrative

Meta narrative: Qatar is trying to Islamize Europe, The Qatari royal family is morally corrupt.

Sub-narratives: Emir of Qatar - homosexual relationship, Qatar Sheikh killed ex-wife & is a pedophile, Qatar is doing a cultural invasion of Europe. Worldwide strategy of Islamic Policy, Qatari plan moved to violent stage.

Impact

Total ad views: 4,204,341. French views: 3,862,756. Brussels views: 303,671. 1.2k likes, 40 comments, 80 shares.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [Smear](#) – Smearing the reputation of the Qatar and their royal family.

[Deliver Ads](#) – Using ads to reach their target audience without revealing the ads' funding source.

[Conceal network identity](#) - the page seems to be hiding its true identity and affiliations.

[Develop AI-Generated Images \(Deepfakes\)](#) – the videos contain AI generated images.

Recommendations

- Action taken: Ads reported to Meta on 14/06/2024 20:05. Update: page taken down by Meta between June 15-17 but no response through the Code of Practice Rapid Response System.
- European Governments notified.

Report	Topic	Evidence	Authors	Content type	Platforms
N/A	Qatar, Islam, Ads	Evidence Sheet	Saman Nazari , A4E	FB post, Ads	Facebook